

An Act

ENROLLED HOUSE
BILL NO. 4427

By: Hilbert, Pogemiller,
Provenzano, Waldron, and
Ranson of the House

and

Seifried of the Senate

An Act relating to teachers; amending Section 1, Chapter 210, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 6-122.12), which relates to an annual report on adjunct teachers; allowing public school districts to employ adjunct teachers who meet certain criteria; directing the State Board of Education to promulgate rules providing certain qualifications for adjunct teachers; prohibiting adjunct teachers from teaching certain subjects in certain grades beginning in certain school year; allowing a district to apply to the Board for certain waiver to continue certain employment; providing eligibility for waiver; prohibiting districts from employing an adjunct teacher for more than certain time period beginning in certain school year; providing for waiver application; allowing the Board to grant a waiver for certain time period; prohibiting certain adjunct teacher from being considered certain teacher; updating statutory reference; updating statutory language; amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 6-122.3, as last amended by Section 162, Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 6-122.3), which relates to alternative certification; removing language directing the Board to promulgate certain rules; updating statutory language; and providing an effective date.

SUBJECT: Teachers

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY Section 1, Chapter 210, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 6-122.12), is amended to read as follows:

Section 6-122.12. A. Public school districts in this state may employ adjunct teachers who have a minimum of a high school diploma and are persons with distinguished qualifications in their field. The State Board of Education shall promulgate rules providing distinguished qualifications for adjunct teachers.

B. 1. Beginning with the 2027-2028 school year, adjunct teachers shall be prohibited from teaching core curriculum subjects including, but not limited to, mathematics, English language arts, science, and social studies in pre-kindergarten through fifth grade.

2. If an adjunct teacher was employed by a public school district to teach a core curriculum subject in pre-kindergarten through fifth grade prior to the 2027-2028 school year, the public school district may apply to the State Board of Education for a waiver to continue the adjunct teacher's employment. To be eligible for a waiver, the adjunct teacher shall be required to complete or shall have completed professional development training in the science of reading provided by the State Department of Education.

If the Board grants the waiver, the public school district may continue to employ the adjunct teacher to teach core curriculum subjects in pre-kindergarten through fifth grade, subject to the limitation provided for in subsection C of this section.

C. Beginning with the 2027-2028 school year, public school districts shall be prohibited from employing an adjunct teacher for more than five (5) years unless the employing public school district applies to the State Board of Education for a waiver. The State Department of Education shall develop a waiver application, which shall include a requirement to submit the adjunct teacher's distinguished qualifications. The Board may grant a waiver allowing the adjunct teacher to be employed for an additional five (5) years.

D. A person employed as an adjunct teacher pursuant to this section who does not hold a valid certificate to teach shall not be considered a teacher as defined by Section 1-116 of this title.

E. The State Department of Education shall publish an annual report on the status of adjunct teachers, authorized by Section 6-

122.3 of ~~Title 70 of the Oklahoma Statutes~~ this title, in this state. The report shall include:

1. Qualifications adopted by the State Board of Education to determine eligibility of adjunct teacher candidates;
2. The subject areas or courses in which adjunct teachers are teaching; and
3. The types of distinguished qualifications adjunct teachers have to make them qualified to teach in certain subject areas or courses.

~~B. F.~~ F. The annual report shall be published on the website of the State Department of Education and copies of the report shall be provided to ~~elected~~ members of the ~~Oklahoma~~ House of Representatives and the ~~Oklahoma State~~ Senate no later than January 15 of each year.

SECTION 2. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 6-122.3, as last amended by Section 162, Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 6-122.3), is amended to read as follows:

Section 6-122.3. A. The State Board of Education shall grant an alternative placement teaching certificate to a person who makes application to the Board and meets the following criteria:

1. a. holds at least a baccalaureate degree from an institution whose accreditation is recognized by the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education and has attained a retention grade point average ~~of~~ not less than 2.50 on a 4.0 scale, or
- b. has successfully completed a terminal degree, such as a doctorate of philosophy, a doctorate in education, professional doctorates, a master of fine arts degree, or a master of library science degree, from an institution accredited by a national or regional accrediting agency which is recognized by the ~~Secretary of the United States Department~~ Secretary of Education. The Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education shall be consulted to verify other terminal degrees, or
- c. holds at least a baccalaureate degree from an institution whose accreditation is recognized by the

Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education and has qualified work experience in a field that corresponds to an area of certification as determined by the State Board of Education, and

- d. in addition to the requirements of subparagraphs a, b ~~and, or~~ c of this paragraph, has demonstrated competency or completed a major in a field that corresponds to an area of specialization for an Elementary-Secondary Certificate or a Secondary Certificate as determined by the State Board of Education or a vocational-technical certificate as recommended by the Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education;

2. Declares the intention to earn standard certification by means of an alternative placement program in not more than three (3) years. The State Board of Education shall determine the subject matter and the number of clock or semester hours required for the professional education component for each person making application for an alternative placement teaching certificate based on the criteria of paragraph 1 of this subsection.

The State Board of Education shall establish a core minimum of six (6) semester hours or ninety (90) clock hours and a maximum of eighteen (18) semester hours or two hundred seventy (270) clock hours for the professional education component.

The requirements set forth in this subsection shall exclude all student teaching requirements pursuant to the provisions of subsection ~~E~~ F of this section;

3. Has passed the subject area portion of the competency examination required in Section 6-187 of this title in the area of specialization for which certification is sought; and

4. Either presents a document from an accredited public school district in this state offering employment in the area of specialization for which certification is sought on condition that the person enroll in an alternative placement program approved by the State Board of Education or declares the intention to seek employment as a teacher at an accredited public school district in this state. The certificate granted pursuant to this subsection shall be considered a ~~"valid certificate of qualification"~~ valid certificate of qualification for the purposes of Sections 6-107 and

6-108 of this title, and the holder of the certificate shall be considered an inductee for the purposes of Section 6-195 of this title.

B. An alternative placement teaching certificate shall be renewed for not more than a maximum of three (3) years upon presentation of a document from an accredited public school district in this state offering renewed employment in the same area of specialization and a document from a teacher education institution verifying satisfactory progress in an appropriate alternative placement program.

C. Persons enrolled in an alternative placement program shall:

1. Have never been denied admittance to a teacher education program approved by the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education, the ~~North Central Association of Colleges and Schools~~ Higher Learning Commission, and by the ~~Oklahoma~~ Commission for Teacher Preparation Educational Quality and Accountability to offer teacher education programs, nor have enrolled in and subsequently failed courses necessary to successfully meet the minimum requirements of the program, except those persons who hold a certificate;

2. Have on file with the director of teacher education at an ~~Oklahoma~~ institution of higher education in this state a plan for meeting standard certification requirements within three (3) years; and

3. Participate in an induction program as required in Section 6-195 of this title and have the same duties and responsibilities as other inductees.

D. The State Board of Education may grant an exception to the requirements for certification and, upon demonstration by an individual of specific competency in the subject area of specialization, may grant a certificate to the individual. The State Board may establish other requirements necessary to grant exceptions.

E. The State Board of Education, in consultation with the Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability, may grant an exception to the requirement to complete a subject area examination for initial certification in a field which does not require an advanced degree pursuant to this section if the candidate has an advanced degree in a subject that is substantially comparable to the

content assessed on a subject area examination. The degree shall be from an institution accredited by a national or regional accrediting agency which is recognized by the United States Secretary of the U.S. Department of Education. The Commission shall provide the Board with the necessary information to determine comparability.

F. Student teaching and a ~~prestudent~~ pre-student teaching field experience shall not be required of alternative placement program participants for standard certification.

~~G. The State Board of Education shall promulgate rules authorizing adjunct teachers who shall be persons with distinguished qualifications in their field. Adjunct teachers shall not be required to meet standard certification. A person employed as an adjunct teacher pursuant to this subsection who does not hold a valid certificate to teach shall not be considered a teacher as defined by Section 1-116 of this title.~~

~~H.~~ Each teacher education institution shall provide the ~~Oklahoma Commission for Teacher Preparation~~ Educational Quality and Accountability an annual report of information as specified by the Commission regarding participation in the alternative placement programs offered by the institution.

~~I.~~ H. The ~~Oklahoma Commission for Teacher Preparation~~ Educational Quality and Accountability shall not accredit, renew the accreditation of, or otherwise approve any teacher education program of any institution of higher education in this state that has not implemented alternative placement programs in at least four areas of specialization, including mathematics, science, and a foreign language. Each institution shall allow individuals who meet the criteria of subsections A and C of this section to be:

1. Admitted to an alternative placement program without further qualification; and

2. Offered the opportunity to complete the requirements for standard certification set forth in subsection A of this section during the summer preceding and the summer following the first year of teaching with an alternative placement teaching certificate. Any person seeking standard certification through an alternative placement program shall be permitted to take necessary courses during regular semesters if offered.

~~J.~~ I. The criteria specified in subsection ~~F~~ H of this section ~~can~~ may be met through a cooperative arrangement entered into by two or more institutions of higher education.

SECTION 3. This act shall become effective November 1, 2026.

Passed the House of Representatives the 6th day of May, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

Passed the Senate the 29th day of April, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate

OFFICE OF THE GOVERNOR

Received by the Office of the Governor this _____
day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.
By: _____

Approved by the Governor of the State of Oklahoma this _____
day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

Governor of the State of Oklahoma

OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY OF STATE

Received by the Office of the Secretary of State this _____
day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.
By: _____